

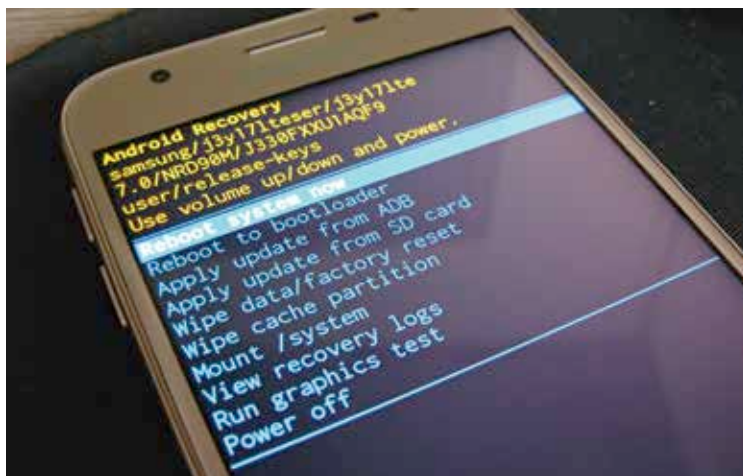
rooted device through a custom recovery of your choice. To know more about custom recoveries, refer to Chapter 2.

Bootloader

Did you know that code execution starts even before your operating system starts up? That code is what you call the bootloader. These bootloaders have their own modification as well as debugging environment. Their job is to package instructions that can boot the OS kernel. Given the fact that the bootloader is the first thing to kick in, even before any of the software on your device fires up, it has to be absolutely specific to different processors. This is precisely why every motherboard has and needs its own bootloader. Each and every Android phone will have a bootloader that can provide instructions to the kernel for it to boot normally.

Why do bootloaders come locked?

When you purchase an Android device, it comes with a locked bootloader. While Android may be open source, the manufacturer of your device would want you to stick with their stock ROM because it is designed specifically for a particular model. So, to prevent you from messing around with the Android OS that they have preloaded onto the device, they lock bootloaders. As long as the bootloader on your device is locked, you will not be able to



You need an unlocked bootloader to be able to successfully root your phone which is a prerequisite for a custom ROM